Topic 19 — World Regional Geography

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

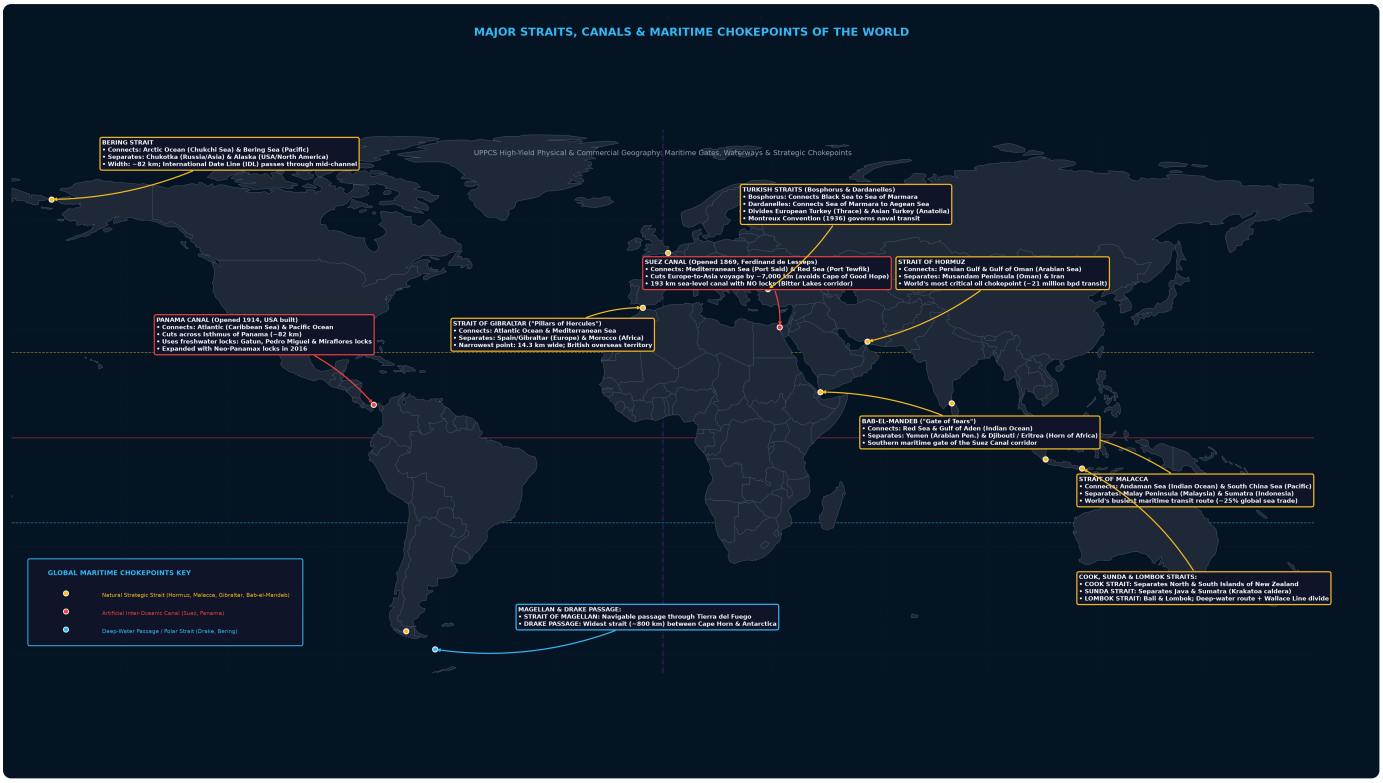
Continents: Asia | Europe | Africa | North America | South America | Australia | Antarctica **Focus belts:** West Asia | Central Asia | South-East Asia | Korean Peninsula | Palestine | Caribbean **Map diet:** South Asia neighbourhood | ASEAN | landlocked / equator / capital-not-the-famous-city | boundary lines | continent size order

Sources baked in: Lucent world regional match-lists; NCERT world map diet; Lucent capitals / landlocked / boundaries notes; **Ghatnachakra** Languages (CB–206+); UPPCS Prelims 2018–2025 **Weight:** ★★★ — country–capital, "which is NOT in this sea/region", Australia interior, Japan plains, W Europe rain, West Asia mountains W→E; teach full regional map **Last verified:** August 2026 — coaching gap-pass (continent order, double-landlocked, boundary lines, capital≠city) **Current Affairs:** none mandatory (static political-map chapter)

Current Affairs (this topic)

Year	Fact	Why it matters	Source
Static	Korea **38th** parallel / USA–Canada **49th** parallel	Boundary-line stems	Atlas
Static	Central Asian capital set (Tashkent–Dushanbe–Bishkek–Ashgabat–Astana)	Stan capital swaps	Atlas
2023–26	West Asia / Palestine map units (Gaza, West Bank) remain high-visibility	Map CA without rewriting physical facts	News / UN
Static	India Antarctic operational pair **Maitri + Bharati**	Polar station stem	MoES / MEA

N.0 Framework — World Regional Geography



Identity: This is a **political + regional map** chapter. Capitals, "which is NOT in the region", landlocked status, equator crossings, and a few physical facts inside each belt all live here.

Learn each continent's **size order** first.

Then learn the **focus belts** — West Asia, Central Asia, South-East Asia, Korea, Palestine and the Caribbean.

Fact **capital ≠ famous city**.

Ankara, Canberra, Brasília and Abu Dhabi are the classic traps.

Fact **landlocked** and **equator** lists separately from the world rivers and world landforms chapters.

Boundary lines such as the 38th, 49th, Durand, Radcliffe and McMahon are short map diet here.

Full political-map drill also lives in the Political Map chapter.

Order of this chapter

1. Asia belts (East, South, West, Central, SE, Korea, Palestine).
2. Europe → Africa → Americas → Australia / NZ → Antarctica → Caribbean.
3. Landlocked · Equator · Capitals · boundary lines.

Teach the **full regional map**. Next year can ask any Lucent capital or landlocked trap, not only Nobi or Bolivia.

N.1 Asia (overview + East + South)

Continent area order: Asia > Africa > North America > South America > Antarctica > Europe > Australia / Oceania.

Asia is the **largest** continent. splits: **East / SE / South / West / Central / North (Siberia)**.

Equator in Asia: Indonesia (Sumatra, Kalimantan, Sulawesi), Maldives fringe — **not** India, **not** China.

Tropic of Cancer (कर्क रेखा): India, Bangladesh, Myanmar, China, Taiwan, UAE/Oman fringe, Saudi, Egypt (Africa).

East Asia	Capital	Physical fact
China	Beijing	Tibet; Hwang Ho / Yangtze; Manchurian plain NE; Tropic through south; Shanghai on Yangtze mouth
Japan	Tokyo	Islands **Hokkaido–Honshu–Kyushu–Shikoku** (N→S). **Kanto** is the Tokyo plain. **Nobi** is the Nagoya plain. These are **not** in Korea (2021)
Mongolia	Ulaanbaatar	Landlocked; Gobi to the south
Taiwan	Taipei	Off Fujian; not Caribbean
North / South Korea	See **N.5**	Peninsula — not the Japanese plains

Siberia / Asian Russia runs from the Urals to the Pacific. The Yenisei port (बंदरगाह) **Igarka** is in **Russia**, not China (2023 port trap). Vladivostok faces the Pacific. Lake Baikal sits in Siberia.

South Asia (India's neighbourhood as a *region*)

Country	Capital	Fact
India	New Delhi	Peninsula; Tropic
Pakistan	Islamabad	Indus (सिंधु); Karachi ≠ capital
Nepal	Kathmandu	**Landlocked**; Himalaya (हिमालय)
Bhutan	Thimphu	**Landlocked**
Bangladesh	Dhaka	Ganga (गंगा)–Brahmaputra (ब्रह्मपुत्र) delta
Sri Lanka	Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte / Colombo	Island; Palk Strait
Maldives	Mal (माल)é	Atolls; equator-near
Afghanistan	Kabul	Landlocked hinge to West/Central Asia; Hindu Kush

India's usual **land** neighbours are **Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Myanmar and Bangladesh**. Some lists also add **Afghanistan** (via PoK). **Sri Lanka and Maldives are sea neighbours.**

> **Logic:** ** Nobi + Kanto → **Japan**. Mongolia and Nepal/Bhutan are the Asian **landlocked** diet with Laos and the ‘stans.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q55

Nobi and Kanto plains are located in which of the following countries?

Options:

A. North Korea

B. South Korea

C. Japan

D. China

Show answer

Ans: C — Kanto = Greater Tokyo. Nobi = Nagoya side of Honshu. A/B are the peninsula trap. D is the “big Asia” dump.

N.2 West Asia

West Asia / Middle East (map): Turkey, Iran, Levant (लेवेंट), Arabian Peninsula, Iraq, Gulf states. **Maghreb** (NW Africa) is often paired in “Arab world” MCQs but sits on the **Africa** card.

Mountains, west → east

Order	Range	Where
1	**Pontic**	North **Turkey**, Black Sea coast
2	**Zagros**	Western **Iran** (Iraq border)
3	**Hindu Kush**	**Afghanistan**
4	**Karakoram** (काराकोरम)	Pakistan–China

Iraq — Sunni Triangle

- Cities **inside** the usual triangle: **Baghdad, Tikrit, Ramadi**.
- **Basra** is far **south**, Shia / Gulf head — **NOT** in the triangle.

Levant & Gulf (map diet)

Country	Capital	Extra
Turkey	Ankara	Pontic + Taurus; Istanbul is **not** the capital
Iran	Tehran	Zagros; Elburz / Damavand

Country	Capital	Extra
Iraq	Baghdad	Tigris; Basra on the Shatt
Saudi Arabia	Riyadh	Rubʿ al-Khali; Mecca / Jeddah west
Syria	Damascus	
Lebanon	Beirut	
Jordan	Amman	East of the Jordan R. / Dead Sea
Yemen	Sanaa	Bab el-Mandeb
Oman	Muscat	
UAE	**Abu Dhabi**	Dubai is not the capital
Qatar	Doha	
Kuwait	Kuwait City	
Bahrain	Manama	
Israel	Jerusalem (claimed)	Mediterranean west

Caucasus (Europe–Asia hinge): Georgia (Tbilisi), Armenia (Yerevan, **landlocked**), Azerbaijan (Baku, Caspian). Elbrus on the Russian side.

Afghanistan sits on West + Central cards: Hindu Kush, landlocked, Kabul; neighbours Iran, PK, TJ, TM, UZ, CN (Wakhan), and historically India via the passes.

Straits on this desk include **Hormuz** (Gulf), **Bab el-Mandeb** (Red Sea), and the **Bosporus / Dardanelles** (Turkey — Europe/Asia). The **Suez Canal** cuts Africa from Asia and joins the Mediterranean to the Red Sea.

Fertile Crescent (phrase): Nile–Levant–Tigris–Euphrates arc — Iraq, Syria, Levant, Egypt.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q48

Which of the following cities is NOT part of the Sunni Triangle in Iraq?

Options:

A. Tikrit

B. Ramadi

C. Basra

D. Baghdad

Show answer

Ans: C — Basra is the southern port. The triangle is the **central-west** belt around Baghdad–Tikrit–Ramadi.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q76

Consider the following mountains and arrange them in correct order from West to East by their location:

1. Karakoram
2. Pontic
3. Hindu Kush
4. Zagros

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Options:

A. 2, 4, 3, 1

B. 2, 3, 4, 1

C. 4, 2, 3, 1

D. 4, 1, 2, 3

Show answer

Ans: A — Pontic (Turkey) → Zagros (Iran) → Hindu Kush (Afghanistan) → Karakoram. Trap **B** puts Hindu Kush before Zagros (too far east already). Trap **C** starts with Zagros and skips that Pontic is further west.

N.3 Central Asia

The five “stans” plus Kazakhstan’s size define this desk. The **Caspian** lies on the west. **China** lies on the east. **Afghanistan** lies on the south.

Country	Capital	Desert / extra
Uzbekistan	**Tashkent**	Aral / Amu-Syr irrigation
Tajikistan	**Dushanbe**	Pamir knot
Kyrgyzstan	**Bishkek**	Tien Shan
Turkmenistan	**Ashgabat**	**Kara Kum / Karakum** desert (2022)
Kazakhstan	**Astana** (Nur-Sultan was the 2019–22 name)	Steppe (स्टेपी); **not** Kara Kum

2019 Q2 listed UZB–TJK–KGZ–TKM against Tashkent–Dushanbe–Bishkek–Ashgabat in that order .

Also on this map: The Aral Sea (Uzbekistan–Kazakhstan) is shrinking. The Caspian touches Kazakhstan, Turkmenistan, Iran, Azerbaijan and Russia. The Wakhan Corridor is Afghanistan’s finger to China. Xinjiang (China) is **not** a “sixth stan” in the five-stan question.

All five stans except Turkmenistan’s western Caspian shore are **landlocked** (Kazakhstan is landlocked despite Caspian — Caspian is a lake).

> **Logic:** ** Kara Kum is **not** Kazakhstan. Kyzylkum straddles UZB–KAZ — different name.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q2

Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List-I (Country)	List-II (Capital)
A. Uzbekistan	1. Tashkent
B. Tajikistan	2. Dushanbe
C. Kyrgyzstan	3. Bishkek
D. Turkmenistan	4. Ashgabat

Options:

A. 1 2 3 4

B. 1 2 4 3

C. 1 3 4 2

D. 1 4 2 3

Show answer

Ans: A — All four (चातुर्यम) are the standard pairs in listed order. Trap **B** swaps Bishkek and Ashgabat.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q106

Kara Kum desert is situated in which of the following countries?

Options:

A. Turkmenistan

B. Tajikistan

C. Kyrgyzstan

D. Kazakhstan

Show answer

Ans: A — Karakum = Turkmenistan. D is the large-stan dump.

N.4 South-East Asia

ASEAN 10: Indonesia, Malaysia, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, Brunei, Vietnam, Laos, Myanmar, Cambodia. (**Timor-Leste** is SE Asia but not the classic 10.)

Country	Capital	Fact
Indonesia	**Jakarta**	Thousands of islands; equator. Port–country pair **Jakarta–Indonesia is correct** (2023)
Malaysia	Kuala Lumpur	Peninsula + **Sabah/Sarawak on Borneo**
Singapore	Singapore	City-state; Malacca approach
Brunei	Bandar Seri Begawan	North Borneo
Philippines	Manila	Luzon / Visayas / Mindanao; Spanish then US
Thailand	Bangkok	Never colonised; Chao Phraya
Myanmar	Naypyidaw (Yangon = old/port)	Pegu Yoma; Bay of Bengal
Laos	Vientiane	**Landlocked**; Mekong
Cambodia	Phnom Penh	Mekong **passes through — delta is not here**
Vietnam	Hanoi (Ho Chi Minh City = south)	**Mekong delta = southern Vietnam** (2021)
Timor-Leste	Dili	East of Indonesia's Timor

Indonesia west → east:Sumatra → Java → Bali → Lombok.

- Sumatra is the big western island (Malacca).
- Java is next (Jakarta).
- Bali then **Lombok** (Wallace Line between Bali and Lombok).
- Trap lists put Java first or Lombok before Bali.

Borneo is shared by Indonesia, Malaysia and Brunei. It is **not** volcanic. **New Guinea** is shared by Indonesia (Papua) and Papua New Guinea (already an island-rank fact).

Mekong: Tibet → China Yunnan → Myanmar → Laos → Thailand → Cambodia → **delta in S Vietnam, not Cambodia**.

Chokes: Malacca (Malay–Sumatra), Sunda (Sumatra–Java), Lombok (Bali–Lombok, oil-tanker alternative).

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q126

With reference to Borneo Island, located in South-East Asia, which of the following statements is/are true?

1. It is divided among three countries.
2. It has been formed due to volcanic deposition.

Options:

A. Neither 1 nor 2

B. Both 1 and 2

C. Only 2

D. Only 1

Show answer

Ans: D — Indonesia, Malaysia, Brunei. Java/Sumatra are the volcanic-arc trap.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q64

To whom does the credit go for the development of coconut and sugarcane agriculture in the Philippines?

Options:

A. French

B. Britishers

C. Hollanders

D. Spanish and Americans

Show answer

Ans: D — Spanish colony (उपनिवेश), then US period. Dutch = Indonesia; British = Malaya/India; French = Indochina.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q71

Which of the following is the correct sequence of the Islands of Indonesia from West to East?

Options:

A. Java, Sumatra, Lombok, Bali

B. Sumatra, Java, Bali, Lombok

C. Sumatra, Java, Lombok, Bali

D. Bali, Sumatra, Java, Lombok

Show answer

Ans: B — Sumatra (west) → Java → Bali → Lombok (east). Trap **C** swaps Bali and Lombok. Trap **A** starts with Java and puts Lombok before Bali.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q121

With reference to Mekong river, which of the following statement/s is/are correct?

1. Mekong rises in Tibetan Plateau
2. Mekong delta is situated in Southern Cambodia.

Options:

A. 1 only

B. 2 only

C. Both 1 and 2

D. Neither 1 nor 2

Show answer

Ans: A — Source Tibet is true. Delta = **southern Vietnam**, not Cambodia.

N.5 Korean Peninsula

Identity: A north–south peninsula hanging off north-east China, divided roughly along the **38th parallel** / DMZ.

	South Korea	North Korea
Capital	**Seoul**	**Pyongyang**
Coast west	Yellow Sea	Yellow Sea
Coast east	East Sea / Sea of Japan	same
Divide	**~38th parallel** / DMZ	

The Korean Peninsula is a **peninsula**. It is **not** an island.

South Korea's capital is **Seoul**.

North Korea's capital is **Pyongyang**.

The west coast faces the **Yellow Sea**.

The east coast faces the East Sea / Sea of Japan.

Busan is South Korea's southern port.

Incheon is Seoul's main port.

The **Yalu / Amnok** is the China–North Korea border river.

The **Tumen** marks the North Korea–China–Russia corner.

The **Taebaek** range is South Korea's eastern backbone.

Nobi and **Kanto** are **Japanese** plains.

Do not park Nobi or Kanto on the Korean card.

N.6 Palestine

Map unit the paper still uses: **historic (ऐतिहासिक) Palestine / Israel–Palestine**.

Piece	Fact
Gaza Strip	Mediterranean coast; borders **Egypt** + Israel
West Bank	West of Jordan River; borders **Jordan** + Israel
Jordan River	Sea of Galilee → **Dead Sea** (no ocean outlet)
Dead Sea	Israel–Jordan; lowest land, saline (लवणीय)
Jerusalem	Claimed capital; Old City holy sites
Ramallah	West Bank administrative centre often in news

Land neighbours of Israel (ring): **Egypt, Jordan, Syria, Lebanon** (+ Palestinian territories). **Not** Iraq (no direct border).

Extra map piece	Fact
Golan Heights	NE; borders **Syria**
Sinai	Egyptian peninsula; Suez Canal on its west; Gaza at its NE corner
Occupied / disputed labels	Learn **where** Gaza, West Bank, Golan sit — do not write a politics essay

N.7 Europe

Belt	Who	Note
Western Europe climate	Britain, NW France, Low Countries	**Westerlies** + **rain in all months** (2024 Both)
Mediterranean Europe	Spain, S France, Italy, Greece	Winter rain — **not** the “all months” fact
British Isles	UK + Ireland	The **UK** is Great Britain plus **Northern Ireland**. **Great Britain** is England, Scotland and Wales. The Republic of Ireland is **not** in the UK. Capital **London**
Iberia	Spain, Portugal	Iberian Peninsula
Benelux	Belgium, Netherlands, Luxembourg	Brussels, **Amsterdam** (government also The Hague), Luxembourg. **Rotterdam** is the Netherlands port (2023 correct pair)
Nordic / Scandinavia	Norway, Sweden, Denmark; Finland + Iceland often bundled	Oslo, Stockholm, Copenhagen, Helsinki, Reykjavik
Baltic states	Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania	Tallinn, Riga, Vilnius
Alps	Switzerland, Austria, parts of FR/IT/DE	Bern, Vienna

Belt	Who	Note
Balkans	Greece, Bulgaria, Serbia, Croatia, Albania, N Macedonia, Bosnia, Montenegro, Kosovo, Romania/Slovenia fringe	Bulgaria holds the Balkan range name
East-Central	Poland, Hungary, Czechia, Slovakia, Ukraine	Warsaw, Budapest, Prague, Kyiv
Russia	Moscow	Europe + Asia; **Igarka** (Yenisei) is in **Russia**, not China

Landlocked Europe (set): Switzerland, Austria, Czechia, Slovakia, Hungary, Serbia, North Macedonia, Kosovo, Belarus, Moldova, Luxembourg, Liechtenstein, Andorra, San Marino, Vatican. **Not** Poland (Baltic), **not** Romania (Black Sea).

Microstates: Vatican, Monaco, San Marino, Liechtenstein, Andorra, Malta (island).

The **Bosporus** at Istanbul joins Europe and Asia inside Turkey. The capital remains **Ankara**.

Suez (1869) shortened **India–Europe** sea distance by about **7,000 km** (2018).

Port–country	Right?
Rotterdam – Netherlands	Yes
Montevideo – Uruguay	Yes
Jakarta – Indonesia	Yes
Igarka – China	**NO** — Igarka is **Russia** (Yenisei, Siberia)

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q75

Consider the following statements with respect to the climate of Western Europe:

1. Western Europe receives rainfall in all months.
2. Western Europe is located in the belt of Westerlies.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

Options:

A. Both 1 and 2

B. Neither 1 nor 2

C. Only 1

D. Only 2

Show answer

Ans: A — Cyclonic rain year-round under the westerlies. Do not apply the **Mediterranean winter-only** rule here.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q29

How much the maritime distance between India and Europe was reduced after the construction of the Suez Canal?

Options:

A. 5,000 km

B. 7,000 km

C. 8,000 km

D. 10,000 km

Show answer

Ans: B — Stock fact **~7000 km**.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q60

Which of the following (Port — Country) is **not** correctly matched?

Options:

A. Rotterdam — Netherlands

B. Igarka — China

C. Montevideo — Uruguay

D. Jakarta — Indonesia

Show answer

Ans: B — Igarka is on the **Yenisei in Russia**. A, C, D are standard correct pairs.

N.8 Africa

Sahara splits **Mediterranean Maghreb** (north) from **sub-Saharan** Africa.

Belt	Countries / fact
Maghreb	Morocco, Algeria, Tunisia, Libya (+ Western Sahara disputed)
Sahel	Senegal–Mauritania–Mali–Burkina–Niger–Chad–Sudan fringe **south of Sahara**
Horn	**Ethiopia, Somalia, Eritrea, Djibouti**. Ethiopia became **landlocked** after **Eritrea** (1993) took the Red Sea

Belt	Countries / fact
West Africa	Nigeria (Abuja, not Lagos as capital), Ghana (घन) (Accra), Senegal (Dakar), Mali (**Bamako**)
Central	DRC (Kinshasa), Congo-Brazzaville, Cameroon, CAR
East	Kenya (Nairobi), Tanzania (Dodoma; Dar es Salaam = port), Uganda (Kampala, landlocked)
Southern	South Africa (Cape Town / Pretoria / Bloemfontein — **three capitals**), Namibia, Botswana (**landlocked**), Zimbabwe (**landlocked**), Zambia (**landlocked**), Mozambique (coast)
Islands	Madagascar (4th largest island), Cape Verde (**Praia**), Mauritius, Seychelles, Comoros. **Madeira / Canary = Atlantic, not "African Caribbean"**

Equator in Africa: Gabon, Congo, DRC, Uganda, Kenya, Somalia (and São Tomé). **Nairobi is south of the equator** (just); **Kampala / Kisangani** near it.

Landlocked Africa (high-yield): Mali, Niger, Chad, CAR, South Sudan, Ethiopia, Uganda, Rwanda, Burundi, Zambia, Zimbabwe, Malawi, Botswana, Lesotho (inside SA), Eswatini. **Not** Kenya, **not** Tanzania, **not** Namibia (Atlantic), **not** Eritrea.

African Great Lakes region: Victoria, Tanganyika, Malawi — Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, DRC, Malawi, Mozambique fringe.

Maghreb capitals (2020 NOT-matched set)

Country	Capital
Morocco	**Rabat** (not Casablanca)
Tunisia	**Tunis**
Algeria	**Algiers**
Libya	Tripoli
Cape Verde (Cabo Verde)	**Praia**
Mali	**Bamako**

2020 Q82: **Cape Verde – Bamako** is the **wrong** pair. Bamako is **Mali**.

Cape of Good Hope / Cape Town sits in south-west South Africa. It is not Cape Verde (Atlantic islands off West Africa).

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q82

Which one of the following is NOT correctly matched? (Country) (Capital)

Options:

A. Morocco – Rabat

B. Tunisia – Tunis

C. Algeria – Algiers

D. Cape Verde – Bamako

Show answer

Ans: D — Cape Verde's capital is **Praia**. Bamako is the capital of **Mali**.

N.9 North America

Country	Capital	Physical spine
Canada	**Ottawa** (not Toronto/Vancouver)	Shield, Prairies, Rockies, Arctic islands; **Baffin**; 49th parallel with USA
USA	**Washington DC** (not New York)	Rockies west, Appalachians east, Great Plains, Mississippi, Great Lakes. **Alaska** (Arctic/Pacific) + **Hawaii** (Pacific islands) are states
Mexico	Mexico City	Plateau; Yucatan; Gulf of Mexico
Greenland	Nuuk	**Denmark**; largest **island**, not a US state

Great Lakes (west → east): Superior → Michigan → Huron → Erie → Ontario → St Lawrence (लॉरेंस). **Lake Michigan** lies wholly in the USA. The others are shared by the USA and Canada.

Central America has seven states: Guatemala, Belize, Honduras, El Salvador, Nicaragua, Costa Rica and **Panama**. The Panama Canal joins the Atlantic and Pacific **with stepped chambers**. Panama is **not** a South American country.

Caribbean has its own card (**N.13**). Bermuda / Bahamas sit in the **Atlantic** more than in the Caribbean *Sea* MCQ.

N.10 South America

The Andes run on the **west**. The Amazon occupies the **north-centre**. The Equator crosses **Ecuador, Colombia and Brazil**. The southern cone is Argentina, Chile and Uruguay.

Country	Capital	Coast?	Regional fact
Brazil	**Brasília** (not Rio / São Paulo)	Atlantic	**Selva** + **Terra Roxa** (2025 both). Amazon
Argentina	Buenos Aires	Atlantic	Pampas; Aconcagua
Chile	Santiago	Pacific	Atacama; **not** landlocked
Peru	Lima	Pacific	Andes; Titicaca with Bolivia. **Not** landlocked (2022 trap)
Ecuador	Quito	Pacific	Equator; Galápagos

Country	Capital	Coast?	Regional fact
Colombia	Bogotá	Caribbean **and** Pacific	
Venezuela	Caracas	Caribbean	Llanos / Orinoco
Bolivia	Sucre (const.) / La Paz (seat)	**Landlocked**	2022 answer. Lost Pacific in 19th c.
Paraguay	Asunción	**Landlocked**	The other S American landlocked state
Uruguay	Montevideo	Atlantic	Port pair 2023 correct. **Not** landlocked
Guyana	Georgetown	Atlantic	Former British Guiana
Suriname	Paramaribo	Atlantic	**Not** landlocked (2022 trap)
French Guiana	Cayenne	Atlantic	France overseas — often in “Guianas”

Landlocked trap set: Uruguay (coast), Suriname (coast), Peru (Pacific) — pick **Bolivia**.

The Falklands / Malvinas are a UK–Argentina dispute in the South Atlantic (not the Caribbean).

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q63

With reference to Brazil, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The equatorial rainforests of Brazil are called "Selva".
2. The fertile dark-coloured soil found there is known as "Terra Roxa".

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Options:

A. Only 2

B. Neither 1 nor 2

C. Both 1 and 2

D. Only 1

Show answer

Ans: C

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q137

Which one of the following is a landlocked country?

Options:

A. Uruguay

B. Suriname

C. Peru

D. Bolivia

Show answer

Ans: D — Bolivia (and Paraguay) are the landlocked pair. Uruguay, Suriname and Peru all have seacoasts.

N.11 Australia

Australia is an island-continent. The **Tropic of Capricorn** cuts it. The interior is **desert / semi-desert** (Great Sandy, Victoria, Gibson, Simpson).

Coast	What sits there
South-west	**Darling Range** (Perth / WA) — 2020
East	**Great Dividing Range**; Sydney, Brisbane
North-east	Great Barrier Reef; tropical Queensland
North	**Tropical** (monsoon / savanna (सवाना)) — **not temperate**
South	Melbourne, Adelaide; more temperate
Tasmania	South of Bass Strait

States and territories are **WA, NT, QLD, NSW, VIC, SA, TAS** plus the **ACT**. **Canberra** is the capital, not Sydney.

Extra	Fact
Outback	Dry interior
Great Artesian Basin	Groundwater under the east-central plains
Murray–Darling	SE basin; not the Darling **Range**
Uluru / Ayers Rock	NT
Tropic of Capricorn	Cuts WA–NT–QLD

New Zealand (Oceania pair — always asked with Australia)

Note	Note
Capital	**Wellington** (not Auckland)
Islands	**North Island + South Island**; **Cook Strait**
Alps	Southern Alps on South Island

Note	Note
Not	An Australian state. Tasmania is the Australian island

Papua New Guinea occupies east New Guinea. Its capital is Port Moresby. It has been independent of Australia since 1975.

Australia trap: interior desert is **true**; northern Australia is **tropical**, not temperate.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q1

Given below are two statements, one is labelled as Assertion (A) and the other as Reason (R).

Assertion (A): The interior part of Australia is desert and semi-desert.

Reason (R): Northern Australia is situated in the temperate zone.

Options:

A. Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A)

B. (A) is false, but (R) is true

C. (A) is true, but (R) is false

D. Both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)

Show answer

Ans: C — Interior *is* dry. North is **tropical**, not temperate. Temperate Australia is the **south**. Interior dryness is subtropical high + continentality, not “because the north is temperate.”

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q76

Darling range is situated along which of the following coasts of Australia?

Options:

A. North-Eastern Coast

B. Southern Coast

C. Eastern Coast

D. South-Western Coast

Show answer

Ans: D — Perth / Indian Ocean side. **Eastern** coast is the **Great Dividing Range** trap (C). NE is the reef (A).

N.12 Antarctica

Identity: Ice-covered continent governed for peace and science under the **Antarctic Treaty (1959)**, in force from **1961**.

India acceded to the Antarctic Treaty in **1983**.

No sovereign private claims are operated as normal national territory under the Treaty system.

Indian work in Antarctica is run through the **National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research (NCPOR)**.

Station	Fact
Dakshin Gangotri	First Indian (1983/84). **Not operational** now (supply base / abandoned as permanent station)
Maitri	1988/89, Schirmacher Oasis — **operational**
Bharati	2012, Larsemann Hills — **operational**

Dakshin Gangotri was India's first Antarctic station (1983–84).

It is **not** an operational permanent station today.

It later served only as a supply / transit note after ice burial.

Maitri was set up in **1988–89** on the **Schirmacher Oasis**.

Maitri is still **operational**.

Bharati was commissioned in **2012** in the **Larsemann Hills**.

Bharati is still **operational**.

India's permanent **operational** pair is **Maitri + Bharati** (मैत्री).

Arya is a fake station name.

Himadri (हिमाद्रि) is India's **Arctic** station in Svalbard. It is **not** Antarctic.

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q53

Which among the following are India's permanent and operational research stations in Antarctica?

Options:

A. Bharati and Arya

B. Bharati and Dakshin Gangotri

C. Bharati and Maitri

D. Dakshin Gangotri and Maitri

Show answer

Ans: C — Arya does not exist. Dakshin Gangotri is **not** the operational pair.

N.13 Caribbean

The **Caribbean Sea** lies between the Greater/Lesser Antilles and Central/South America.

Group	Islands
Greater Antilles	Cuba, Jamaica, Hispaniola (**Haiti + Dominican Republic**), Puerto Rico
Lesser Antilles (names)	**Grenada, Montserrat, Anguilla**, Barbados, Trinidad (S edge), Antigua
NOT Caribbean	**Madeira** (Portugal, NE Atlantic off Morocco), Canary Islands (Spain, Atlantic), **Azores**, **Cape Verde**, Bermuda (N Atlantic)
Island	Capital / extra
--------	----------
Cuba	Havana; largest Caribbean island
Jamaica	Kingston
Haiti / Dominican Rep.	Port-au-Prince / Santo Domingo — **one island, two countries**
Puerto Rico	US territory
Trinidad and Tobago	Port of Spain; near Venezuela
Bahamas	Atlantic archipelago — often **not** the “Caribbean **Sea**” MCQ

Inline PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2021, Q104

Which of the following Islands is NOT located in the Caribbean Sea?

Options:

A. Grenada

B. Montserrat

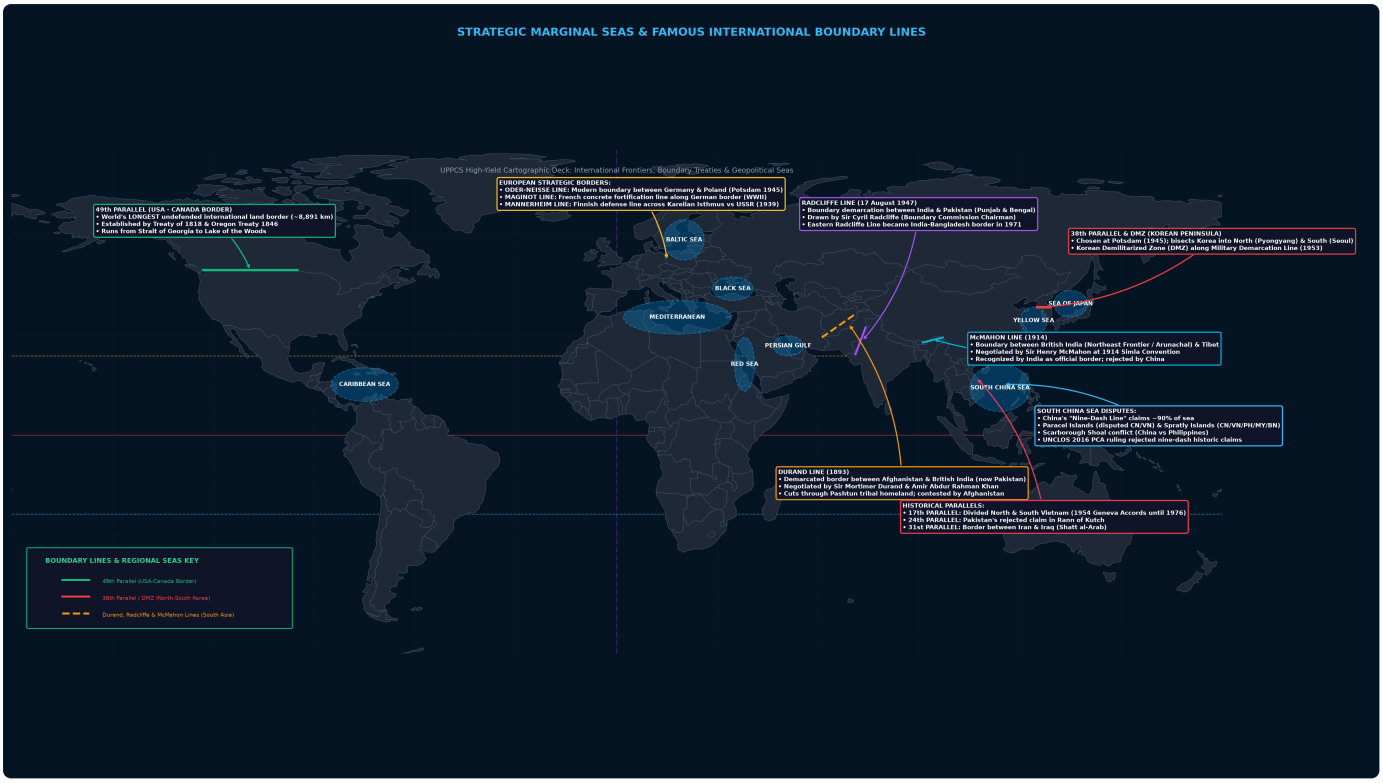
C. Madeira

D. Anguilla

Show answer

Ans: C — Madeira = Portuguese Atlantic. A, B, D are Lesser Antilles / Caribbean.

N.14 Landlocked · Equator · Capitals · Boundaries (map diet)



South America landlocked:Bolivia + Paraguay only. Uruguay / Peru / Suriname have coasts.

Asia landlocked (core): Mongolia, Nepal, Bhutan, Laos, Afghanistan, the five stans (Caspian ≠ ocean), Armenia, (plus Central Asian neighbours).

Double-landlocked: a landlocked country surrounded only by other landlocked states — **Uzbekistan** (Asia) and **Liechtenstein** (Europe).

Africa landlocked (core): Ethiopia (post-Eritrea), Mali, Niger, Chad, Uganda, Zambia, Zimbabwe, Botswana, Malawi, Rwanda, Burundi, South Sudan, CAR, Lesotho, Eswatini.

Equator countries : Ecuador, Colombia, Brazil, Gabon, Congo, DRC, Uganda, Kenya, Somalia, Indonesia, Maldives, Kiribati. **Not** India. **Not** Australia (Capricorn, not Equator).

Prime Meridian: runs through the UK (Greenwich), France, Spain, Algeria, Mali, Burkina Faso, Togo, Ghana — **not** through India.

Boundary lines (short map diet)

Line	Note
38th parallel	Approx. Korea DMZ / North–South Korea
49th parallel	Much of **Canada–USA** border
Durand Line	Afghanistan–Pakistan
Radcliffe Line	India–Pakistan (1947)
McMahon Line	India–China (eastern sector)
Maginot / Siegfried	Historic France–Germany fortification names

Capitals that are NOT the famous city

Country	Capital	Famous non-capital
Australia	**Canberra**	Sydney
Brazil	**Brasília**	Rio / São Paulo
Turkey	**Ankara**	Istanbul
Nigeria	**Abuja**	Lagos
Tanzania	**Dodoma**	Dar es Salaam
South Africa	Pretoria / Cape Town / Bloemfontein	Johannesburg
USA	**Washington DC**	New York
Canada	**Ottawa**	Toronto
Morocco	**Rabat**	Casablanca
UAE	**Abu Dhabi**	Dubai
New Zealand	**Wellington**	Auckland
Pakistan	**Islamabad**	Karachi
Myanmar	**Naypyidaw**	Yangon
Bolivia	Sucre / La Paz	—
Netherlands	Amsterdam	Rotterdam (port); The Hague = government/ICJ

N.15 World languages

Linguistic counts often split **L-1** (mother tongue / primary) and **L-2** (second language). Total speakers ≈ L-1 + L-2.

Ethnologue-style ranks (ranks move by year — learn the usual leaders):

Note	Fact
Largest by **L-1**	Often **Mandarin Chinese**
Largest by **total** (L-1+L-2) in recent Ethnologue frames	Often **English**
Hindi	Huge L-1 + L-2; classic “top world languages” set
Spanish	Official across much of Latin America

Esperanto is an artificial international auxiliary language (Zamenhof). It is not a country’s official tongue.

Country / place	Language
Singapore	Official set includes **Malay** (national), **English**, **Mandarin**, **Tamil**
Chile / Colombia / Cuba	**Spanish** official
Republic of Congo	**Not** Spanish (French / local)
Myanmar	**Burmese** (not Tamil as major)
Indonesia	**Bahasa Indonesia** (Bahasa ≠ Thailand)
Denmark / Netherlands / China	Danish / Dutch / Mandarin
Pakistan	**Urdu + English** official; Punjabi widely spoken but not the sole "official = Punjabi" story
Bangladesh	Stronger **ethnic/linguistic homogeneity** than Pakistan in classic A/R stems

Mauritius languages. English and French are the main official languages of administration and education. Mauritian Creole is the everyday spoken tongue for most people. Hindi, Urdu, and Bhojpuri are widely used in Indo-Mauritian communities. Hakka Chinese is spoken in parts of the Chinese-Mauritian community.

Americas language map pair: French (e.g. Guiana), Portuguese (**Brazil**), Spanish (most of Spanish America), English (parts of Caribbean / North).